

ance sheets can be optimised so that they can use their existing resources most effectively.

However, since the pandemic, there has been a realisation that MDBs need to integrate global challenges such as climate change, pandemics, etc., within their core development mandate. This would need a reform in the existing frameworks of functions of MDBs and expansion of their existing financial resources. This is a felt need across the entire Global South.

During our presidency we have been able to effectively steer this issue. Unlike earlier, the call for reforms of the MDBs are now coming from the shareholders of the MDBs themselves and this has ensured that there is a lot more traction around the Indian presidency's MDB agenda. Shareholders of the MDBs now realise the importance of the issue.

The presidency established the G20 Independent Expert Group on Strengthening MDBs. The Group comprises some of the best global minds on international financial architecture. The Group has submitted Volume 1 of its report, and Volume 2 will be presented in October.

The recommendations of the expert group largely echo India's thoughts on enhancing the financial strength of MDBs, increasing the lending levels to meet the core mandates of eliminating poverty and fostering shared prosperity along with addressing emerging global challenges. Through this report and dialogues to build consensus, India has effectively embedded the priorities of the Global South in the larger global conversation on MDB reforms.

Q: India's digital public infrastructure of the India Stack and services such as Aadhaar, UPI, Co-WIN and Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana have been immensely successful in providing services directly to beneficiaries. How far has India been able to showcase these as a viable



model for development at the G20 and help other countries use these successfully?

A: Inclusive growth is the first requirement for social justice and inclusive growth needs last mile delivery. India has shown that technology can be a big enabler of ensuring last mile delivery. Technology has helped India achieve targeted welfare delivery.

Our use of technology has been aimed at inclusive growth and formalisation. The use of technology in Aspirational districts has led to significant improvement in various indicators. It has not only led to improved formalisation but also availability of affordable credit and other facilities for the poor.

Today, there is global acknowledgement of India's success in promoting and using digital public infrastructure towards socio-economic development of our people. The fact that 46 per cent of global digital payments transactions are now in India is one shining